

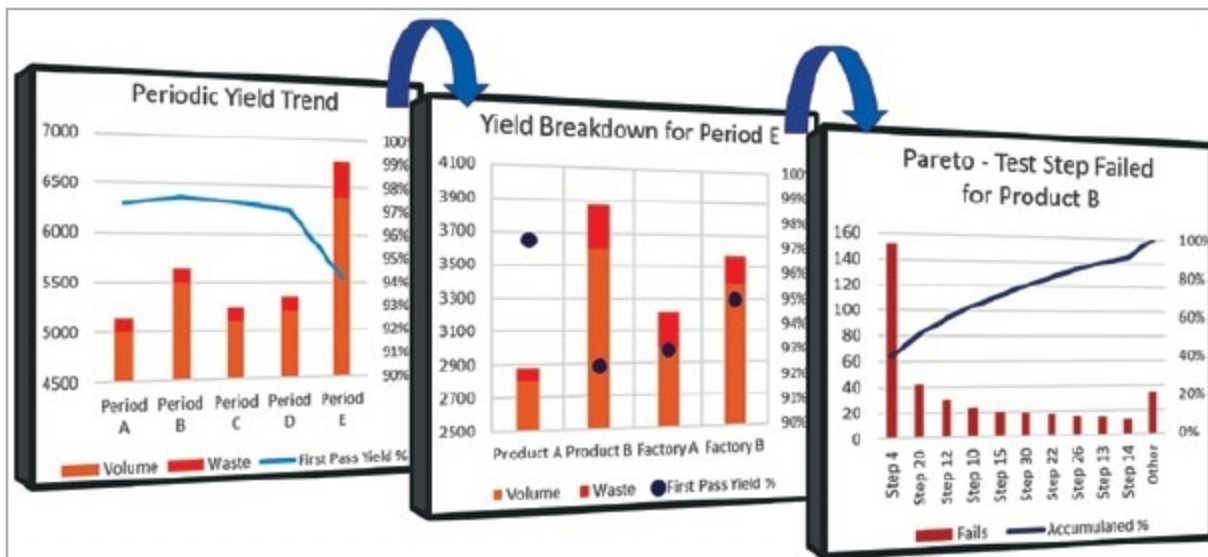


Fig. 4: Real-time dashboards and drill down capabilities allow you to quickly identify the contributors to poor performance. Here, it is apparent that product B has a single failure contributing to around 50 per cent waste. There is no guarantee that step 4 is included in monitored KPIs within a SPC system, but it is critical that the trend is brought to your attention

rule of thumb for dashboards is that unless the information is given to you, it would not be acted on. None of us have time to go looking for trouble.

As a next step, it is critical that you can quickly drill down to a Pareto view of your most occurring failures, across any of these dimensions. By

now, it could be that the tools from SPC become relevant to learn more details. But now you know that you are applying it on something of high relevance, not based on educated guesses. You suddenly find yourself in a situation where you can prioritise initiatives based on a realistic cost-benefit ratio.

Repair data

Presence of repair data in your system is also critical—it cannot be exclusively contained in an MES system or external repair tool. Repair data supplies contextual data that improves root-cause analysis, and contains other benefits. From a human resource point of view, it also tells you if products are blindly retested, as sometimes, normal process variations take the measurement within pass-fail limits. Or, if the products are, in fact, taken out of the standard manufacturing line and fixed, as intended. Have no illusions, it is not rare to see products being retested more than 10 times within the same hour.

In short, quality influencing actions come from informed decisions. Unless you have a data management approach that can give you the full picture, across multiple operational dimensions, you can never optimise your product and process quality or company profits. You cannot fix what you do not measure! **EFY**

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